Léa sighed and looked out the window. “Even if he has access to the shelters, it will be an experience like no other.” She watched the river running alongside the tracks. “Maybe those who do survive will wish they hadn’t.”

“If I can save him, I must try. What’s the worst that will happen? Reinhardt will say no.”

Léa reached over and touched Rose’s knee. “I’m proud of you. It takes a lot of courage to face a Gestapo officer and ask him to do things to help others.” Her respect for Rose beamed bright in her eyes. “Maman would be proud, too, if she were here now.”

Rose wanted to say it had nothing to do with courage. Every time she stood alone in the room with Reinhardt, dread and fear coursed through her veins, but what terrified her more was letting those feelings render her helpless, so she did nothing. She’d lived like that for too long, and she wasn’t going back.